

March 15th 2025

Memo to the Office of Science and Technology Policy

Protecting Independent Content Creators in the Age of Generative AI

To: Office of Science and Technology Policy

From: Michael Sanchez, CEO of Raptive (raptive.com)

Subject: AI Action Plan : Seizing the Opportunity to Stand Up for America's Small Businesses
On America's Digital Mainstreet

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Overview

Raptive, a company dedicated to empowering over 5,200 of the largest and most influential independent content creators in the United States, wishes to bring to your attention an urgent matter that presents both a challenge and an opportunity for OSTP. The rapid advancement of generative AI technology poses significant risks to over 100,000 independent content creators—small business owners who embody the entrepreneurial spirit of our nation.

These creators rely on open access to digital audiences for their livelihoods, and the shift toward AI-driven content delivery threatens to disrupt their revenue streams, dilute intellectual property rights, and undermine the open web. In our response, we detail the challenges faced by these vital contributors to America's digital economy and present targeted policy recommendations to ensure that AI innovation continues to flourish without compromising the interests of small business owners and independent voices.

This is a pivotal moment to address these challenges and ensure that independent content creators—who play a vital role in the digital economy—are not left behind. Thoughtful policy action can help protect small businesses, promote fair competition, and ensure that technological innovation continues to flourish without undermining the livelihoods of hardworking Americans.

The Opportunity for the Office of Science and Technology Policy

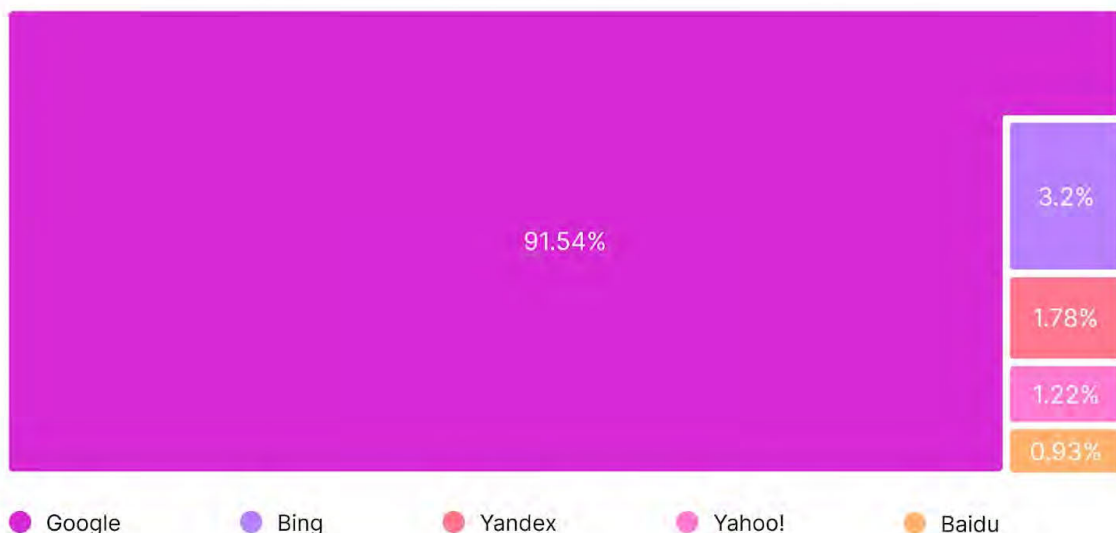
OSTP is uniquely positioned to champion the cause of independent content creators. By standing up against monopolistic practices and ensuring fair competition, you can reinforce America's leadership in innovation while safeguarding the rights of small business owners.

Key Concerns and Benefits to the OSTP

1. Protecting Small Businesses from Tech Monopolies

- **Issue Explanation:** Tech giants like Google are leveraging AI to consolidate control over content distribution. Their AI Overviews transform search results into comprehensive answers that keep users within their ecosystem, bypassing independent creators' websites.
- **Impact on Creators:** This practice undermines the revenue streams of small business owners who rely on website traffic, threatening their livelihoods.
- **Benefit to the OSTP:** By addressing these monopolistic practices, OSTP can protect small businesses, demonstrating your unwavering commitment to fair competition and the free market—principles that resonate deeply with the American people.

Search Engine Market Share Worldwide



Source: StatCounter Global Stats

Google already controls an overwhelming amount of online search. With no realistic alternatives, excluding yourself from Google's search index, AI training, or AI overviews is a death sentence for small independent content creators who rely on Google search for about half of the traffic that is sent to their site.

2. Ensuring Ethical Use of AI in Search Engines

- **Issue Explanation:** AI-generated summaries in search results provide information without directing users to the original content sources, diminishing creators' control over their work and potentially misrepresenting it.
- **Impact on Creators:** Reduced traffic and engagement undermine their ability to monetize content and maintain their businesses.
- **Benefit to the OSTP:** Addressing this concern showcases your dedication to ethical technology use and supports the rights of content creators, reinforcing America's moral leadership on the global stage.

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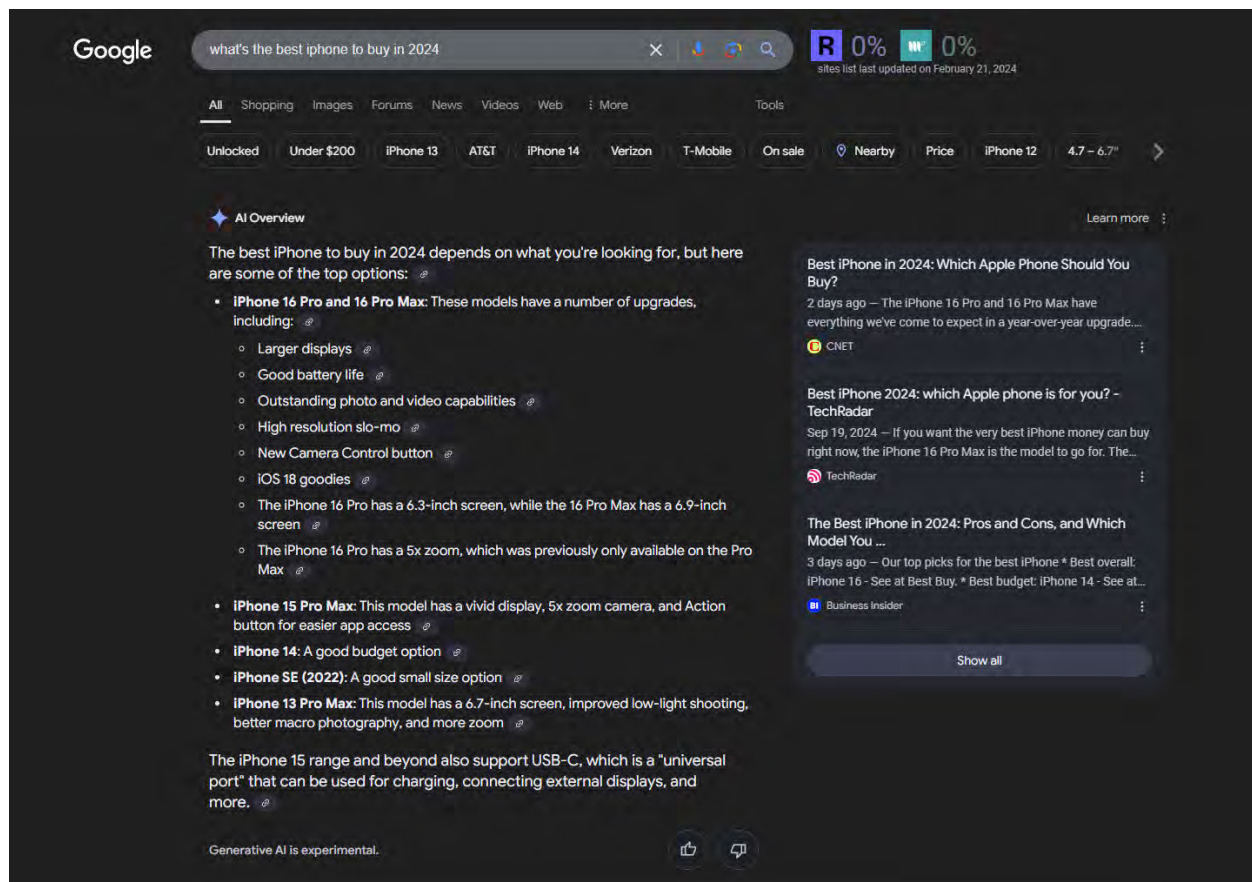
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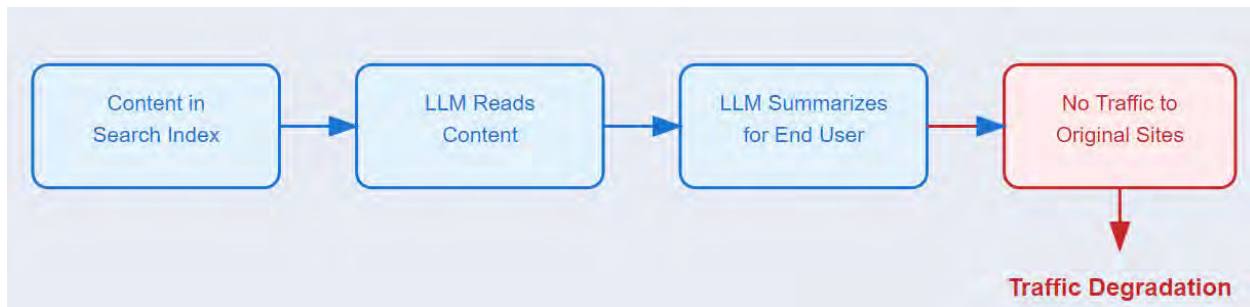
Traditional Search Engine Results Pages (SERPs) simply provided a list of links to choose from, directing valuable traffic to the open web.



Google's AI Overviews provides attribution, but largely summarizes webpage content, diverting valuable traffic away from the websites whose content they are utilizing. Other AI tools like ChatGPT only provide attribution if they search the web, which they don't always do in order to provide an answer.

3. Preventing the Decline of the Open Web

- **Issue Explanation:** The shift towards AI Overviews and the reduction of support for open web technologies threaten the open internet, a cornerstone of free speech and innovation.
- **Impact on Creators:** Independent creators face increased challenges in distribution and monetization, jeopardizing their contributions to our digital landscape.
- **Benefit to the OSTP:** By promoting a free and open internet, the OSTP can uphold the values of free speech and competition, ensuring that America's digital economy remains vibrant and powerful.

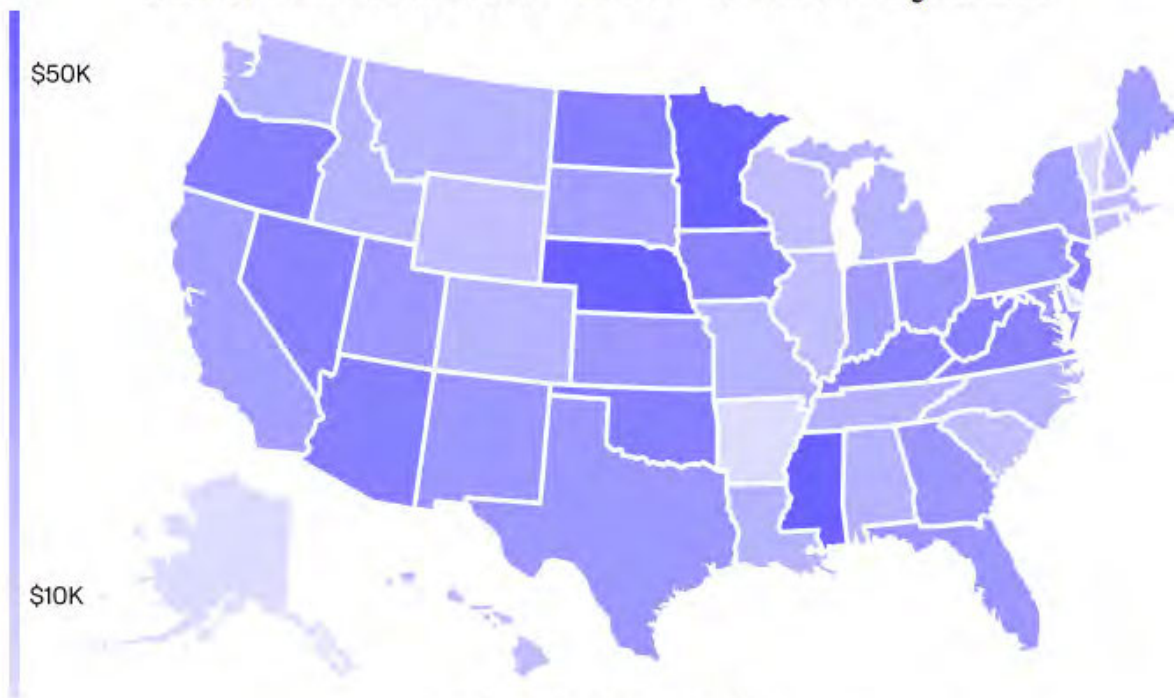


New AI powered search engine features will lead to a degradation of traffic to web pages as LLMs become better at providing answers directly on the search page.

4. Upholding Intellectual Property and Revenue Protections

- **Issue Explanation:** Without proper safeguards, creators' intellectual property can be used by AI tools without consent or compensation, undermining their rights.
- **Impact on Creators:** This exploitation threatens the economic models that support creativity and entrepreneurship.
- **Benefit to the OSTP:** Protecting intellectual property rights aligns with your commitment to the rule of law and supports the economic interests of small businesses across the nation.

Median individual creator income by state



Source: Raptive Data Studio, May 2024

Creators across the country rely on revenue from their site as their sole source or a supplement for their income. To date Raptive creators have generated billions of dollars in revenue.

The OSTP is Perfectly Positioned to Address this Issue

The OSTP's steadfast support for small businesses and track record of challenging unfair practices uniquely position it to tackle this problem effectively. OSTP's leadership can ensure that American innovation thrives while safeguarding the rights and livelihoods of independent creators. By taking decisive action, you reinforce America's commitment to fairness, competition, and the entrepreneurial spirit that drives our nation forward.

Next Steps

1. Maintain and Strengthen Intellectual Property Protections

○ Action Steps:

- Ensure that any changes to AI regulations do not weaken existing intellectual property laws.
- Reinforce the enforcement of copyright protections in the context of AI development, ensuring creators' work is not used without consent.

○ Expected Outcomes:

- Safeguarding creators' rights and encouraging continued innovation.
- Promoting respect for intellectual property within the AI industry.

2. Encourage Market-Based Revenue Solutions

○ Action Steps:

- Facilitate the development of private-sector revenue-sharing models that fairly compensate creators when their content is used by AI tools.
- Promote industry-led initiatives for licensing agreements between AI companies and content creators.

○ Expected Outcomes:

- Preservation of creators' income through fair compensation.
- Incentivization of innovation in both the AI and creator sectors.

3. Promote Free Speech and Fair Competition

○ Action Steps:

- Monitor and address any anti-competitive practices by tech giants that disadvantage independent creators.
- Encourage transparency in AI algorithms and require clear attributions and links to original content sources in AI-generated summaries.

○ Expected Outcomes:

- Protection of the open web and the free flow of information.
- A competitive digital marketplace that supports innovation and entrepreneurship.

4. Collaborate with Independent Creators

- **Action Steps:**

- Engage directly with representatives of the creator economy to understand their challenges and perspectives.
- Foster partnerships between AI developers and creators to explore mutually beneficial solutions.

- **Expected Outcomes:**

- Development of AI technologies that support, rather than undermine, the creator economy.
- Strengthened relationships between the federal government, creators, and the tech industry.

5. Consider Legislative Efforts Addressing Unfair Tech Practices

- **Action Steps:**

- Review concerns regarding tech companies' use of AI to engage in exclusionary practices.
- Promote policies that ensure a level playing field for independent creators and prevent monopolistic behavior by dominant tech firms.

- **Expected Outcomes:**

- Protection of free market competition, ensuring that no single company can unfairly dominate the AI landscape.
- Support for independent creators, fostering innovation and entrepreneurship.

About Raptive

Raptive is a powerful advocate for independent content creators, supporting over 5,200 unique voices across America and beyond. By partnering with these creators—small business owners, entrepreneurs, and innovators—we help them build successful online businesses. Through state-of-the-art technology and business support, Raptive empowers individuals to grow their influence, reach new audiences, and generate real income without relying on large media corporations.

We stand for a free and open internet where independent creators can thrive without interference from tech giants. We are committed to protecting and amplifying these voices, ensuring that diverse and patriotic perspectives are heard across the web.

Conclusion

This is a significant opportunity for OSTP to champion the cause of small businesses and independent creators across America. By addressing the challenges posed by generative AI, you can ensure that technological innovation proceeds hand in hand with respect for intellectual property and the livelihoods of entrepreneurs.

OSTP leadership on this issue will not only protect a vital sector of our economy but also reinforce America's values of fairness, competition, and the entrepreneurial spirit that makes our nation exceptional.

We at Raptive stand ready to support you in this endeavor and offer ourselves as a resource as you explore these issues. Together, we can work towards solutions that benefit all Americans and uphold the principles that underpin our great nation.

Relevant Sources

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- **Headlines**
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 - [Creator Stories](#)
 - [The Woks of Life](#)
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